

Pre-Analysis Planning in Non-Academic Research

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Introduction

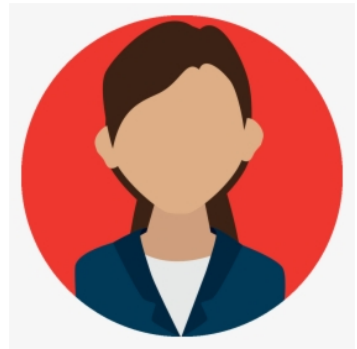
Introductions

What to expect

- Discussion!
Interrupt me, ask questions, give personal examples, debate, argue, etc.
- Be respectful

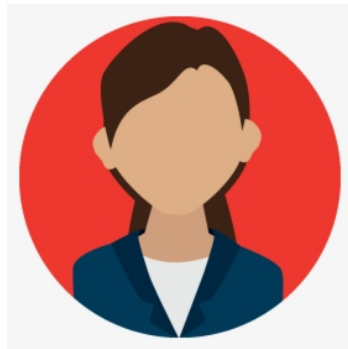


Academic vs professional research



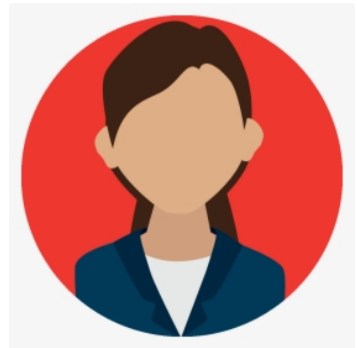
How are research outcomes used?
What pressures are put on researchers?
Where do these pressures come from?
What quality control checks are established?

Academic vs professional research



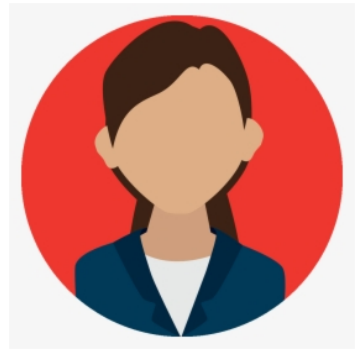
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Deontology vs Consequentialism

Deontology

Rule-based, focus on the rightness or wrongness of each action (e.g., don't lie)

Consequentialism

Result-based, focus on the consequences of the action (e.g., it is okay to lie to protect someone's feelings)

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Academic vs
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Ethics
Theories

Scenarios

Pre-
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Applications

Consulting for EPA

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What pressures and constraints are put on you as a researcher?

Consulting for EPA



How would you respond to the request if you were a manager?

Consulting for EPA

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How would you respond as a
entry-level employee?

Consulting for state litigators

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Consulting for state litigators



What normative beliefs might you hold as a researcher? How might these beliefs affect your research?

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How should you present the conflicting results from the two data sources?

Consulting for state litigators



Do your responses follow a
deontology or
consequentialism ethical
standard?

Pre-specification in non-academic contexts

Applications/Benefits

- Aligns client and researcher expectations
- Strengthens researchers' ability to resist client pressures
- Keeps researcher biases in check (deontology rather than consequentialism)
- Protects researcher/firm reputation

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What a non-academic "PAPs" might look like

- Detailed scope of work
- Pre-analysis agreement between client and contractor about which data sources and outcome variables will be used

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How might a PAP have helped researchers in the two scenarios we discussed?